Whistleblower Policy

Authority: Board of Directors	**Date Ratified:** April 28, 2025
	Next Review Date: April, 2028
Previous Amendments: n/a	
Related Document(s): Chief Operating Officer Policy; Whistleblower Procedure	
Review Committee(s): Human Resources Committee of the Board	
Delegates: Chief Operating Officer Senior Manager, People and Development	

PURPOSE

The USC requires directors, executives, and employees to observe high standards of personal and professional ethics in the conduct of their duties and responsibilities. This policy outlines the responsibilities of all paid employees of the USC in reporting suspected fraud or other misconduct.

Staff, board members, volunteers, and community members are encouraged to report suspected fraudulent or dishonest conduct so that the USC can address and correct inappropriate conduct and actions. This policy supplements, and does not replace, any procedures required by law.

1. DEFINITIONS

2. REPORTING RESPONSIBILITY

2.1. It is the responsibility of all board members, officers, employees and volunteers to report concerns about violations of the USC's approved policies or suspected violations of law or regulations that govern the USC's operations.

3. NO RETALIATION

3.1. It is contrary to the values of the USC for anyone to retaliate against any board member, officer, employee or volunteer who in good faith reports an ethics violation, or a suspected violation of law, such as a complaint of discrimination, or suspected fraud, or suspected violation of any regulation governing the operations of the USC.

3.2. An employee who retaliates against someone who has reported a violation in good faith is subject to discipline up to and including termination of employment.

4. ACTING IN GOOD FAITH

4.1. Anyone filing a written complaint concerning a violation or suspected violation must be acting in good faith and have reasonable grounds for believing the information disclosed indicates a violation.

4.2. Any allegations that prove not to be substantiated and which prove to have been made maliciously or knowingly to be false will be viewed as a serious disciplinary offense.

5. CONFIDENTIALITY

5.1. Violations or suspected violations may be submitted on a confidential basis by the complainant.

5.2. Reports of violations or suspected violations will be kept confidential to the extent possible, consistent with the need to conduct an adequate investigation. This may include disclosure to third party legal counsel as required to conduct the investigation.

6. HANDLING REPORTED VIOLATIONS

6.1. Suspected violations of approved USC policy, fraud, or other misconduct should be reported to the Chief Operating Officer.

6.1.1. If the report includes an allegation against the Chief Operating Officer, the violation shall be reporting to the Senior Manager, People and Development.

6.1.2. If a report includes an allegation against a member of the USC's Executive, the report shall be made in accordance with the Executive Officer Accountability and Discipline Policy.

6.2. All reports will be promptly investigated and appropriate corrective action taken if warranted, in accordance with the Whistleblower Procedure.